

TV to Become More Interactive With **DiiVA**

A DiiVA-enabled TV lets you access the Internet, control devices, play games and reduce cable usage

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TTV has become our window to the world with an ever-increasing number of interfaces. Amazingly, it has developed from being a simple device for entertainment to a multi-cable, remote-control-managed experience. Yet, throughout these developments, TV could never develop into a tool to control other devices. The digital interactive in-



terface for video and audio (DiiVA) specification, though, gives TV a new definition.

With DiiVA specification 1.0, developed by a consortium of companies, one can access the Internet and control devices from any DiiVA-enabled TV, reduce cable usage and play games on the TV. In fact, the main aim of DiiVA is to make

consumer electronics devices connect to a network so that every TV on a network can control them.

Be it a tech-savvy executive or an average home user, all need to integrate their electronics entertainment devices and digital appliances. This integration sometimes gets cumbersome and managing it becomes a serious issue. DiiVA—a new home multimedia networking interface standard that incorporates uncompressed video,

multichannel audio, bidirectional data such as USB and Ethernet, commands and content protection—will be able to handle this challenge. It would rather simplify connection between devices, offer easy configuration and make user experience a simple and better one. In other words, DiiVA can be thought of as high-definition multimedia interface (HDMI), universal serial bus (USB) and Ethernet bundled together.

According to Manish Sharma, associate professor, IIT Delhi, “A good thing about DiiVA is its viability. Market leaders like Sharp, Panasonic, LG, Samsung, Media Tek, Agilent and many other firms are supporting this standard.”

The consortium released the DiiVA 1.0 specification in April this year, but products that can use this interface will be available by 2010. This specification is open to companies developing consumer electronics products like TVs, set-top boxes, DVDs, Blu-ray players, AV receivers, PCs, gaming consoles and mobile devices enabling technology.

Benefits for end users

DiiVA will bring along with it simplicity and scalability for the end users. Today, consumer electronics products can be connected to one another, but each has its own type of connectors, making the task troublesome. DiiVA specification tries to standardise the interface for consumer electronics products so that home networking becomes simple. Consumer electronics products have the functionality of two-way communication, hence DiiVA will give